Short link to syllabus: https://bit.ly/657-spring2026

Pratt School of Information
144 W. 14th St., room 602
New York, NY 10011-7301

INFO: 657
Digital Humanities

Course Information
Section: INFO-657-02
Semester: Spring 2026
Meeting Dates & Times: Wednesdays, 3:00pm-5:50pm
Location: Pratt Manhattan Campus, room 612
Credits: 3
Prerequisites or other restrictions: None

Instructor Contact Information
Filipa Calado, PhD (she)
Office Location: Pratt Manhattan Campus, room 602
Office Hours: Tuesdays 1:00pm-2:30pm, room 602, and Thursdays 3:30pm - 5pm on zoom, sign-up required.
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Course Description:
This course examines the history, theory, and practice of digital humanities, paying special attention to the ways in which digital humanities are transforming research, disciplines, and even the academy itself. Topics include contrasts and continuities between traditional and digital humanities; tools and techniques used by digital humanists; the processes of planning, funding, managing, and evaluating digital humanities projects; ways in which the digital humanities impact scholarly communication and higher education; and the special roles of libraries and information professionals in this growing movement.

Course Goals & Learning Outcomes:
The goals of this course are to:
- explore various theoretical and applied perspectives on the digital humanities
- develop familiarity with a wide range of digital humanities projects, methods, and tools
- build skills in planning, developing, and evaluating digital humanities projects

By the end of this course, students will be able to:
- critically discuss digital humanities in light of current theories and methods
- explain how digital humanities methods and practices are applied in different disciplines
- conduct basic digital humanities research and research-supporting activities
- facilitate digital humanities work at various levels and stages

Required Texts & Course Website:
All readings are directly linked on the course schedule.

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Course Format:
This course is a survey of the digital humanities, which includes a mix of presentations, workshops, discussion, and a final project. You are required to review the assigned materials in advance of each session and prepare to discuss them with the class.

Course Schedule and Readings:

Week	Date	Topic, Readings, and Assignments
Unit 1: Introduction to DH data and tools		
1	1/28	**Introduction to class** In class: 1) What is Digital Humanities? (generate 5 different quotes) 2) Matthew K. Gold and Lauren F. Klein, "Introduction: the Digital Humanities, Moment to Moment", In *Debates in the Digital Humanities 2023.* 3) Matthew Kirschenbaum, "Prepare for the Textpocalypse", March 8, 2023. Part 1: Review the syllabus, get to know each other. What do we mean by "digital," "humanities," and "digital humanities"? Part 2: In-class readings and discussion
2	2/4	**What is the digital humanities?** Readings: 1) Lauren Tilton, David Mimno, and Jessica Marie Johnson. "Introduction: What Gets Counted: Computational Humanities under Revision" in *Computational Humanities*. 2024. 2) Jacqueline Wernimont and Elizabeth Losh. 2018. "Introduction" In *Bodies of Information: Intersectional Feminism and Digital Humanities*, edited by Jacqueline Wernimont and Elizabeth Losh. University of Minnesota Press. 3) Zach Blas, Melody Jue, and Jennifer Rhee, "Introduction: Chart of Transitions" from Informatics of Domination, 2025. 4) Choose **one** article to read from Part One of *Bodies of Information: Intersectional Feminism and Digital Humanities*. Be prepared to share your take on the reading in class. Part 1: Discussion on readings Part 2: Discussion continued; the Tools of DH and Programming Historian
3	2/11	**Humanities data** Readings: 1) Katie Rawson and Trevor Muñoz "Against Cleaning" from *Debates in the Digital Humanities* (2019) 2) Miriam Posner "Humanities Data: A Necessary Contradiction" (2015) 3) Johanna Drucker "Humanities Approaches to Graphical Display" in *Digital Humanities Quarterly* (2011) 4) Choose **one** article to read from Part Two: Values in *Bodies of Information: Intersectional Feminism and Digital Humanities*. Be prepared to share your take on the reading in class.

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Part 1: Tutorial TBD by Craig Fahner (3pm - 4pm)
Part 2: Discussion on readings

4 2/18 **DH tools part 1: text encoding**
Readings:
1) Oscar Wilde, *The Picture of Dorian Gray* (1890), Chapter 1. (optional: chapters 2 and 3)
2) Alison Hedley and Lorraine Janzen Kooistra, "Prototyping Personography for The Yellow Nineties Online: Queering and Querying History in the Digital Age " In *Bodies of Information: Intersectional Feminism and Digital Humanities*, edited by Jacqueline Wernimont and Elizabeth Losh. University of Minnesota Press.

Part 1: Start TEI workshop
Part 2: Begin tutorial assignment

5 2/25 **DH tools part II:**

Sample tutorials (review in class):
- Build a webpage from scratch with HTML and CSS
- Analyze DH conference abstracts with Voyant
- Snoop on network activity with Wireshark
- Getting Started with OpenRefine
- Getting Started with the Command Line
- Getting Started with Tableau

Part 1: TEI workshop continue: TEI starter code here
Part 2: Develop tutorials, review sample tutorials

Bring to class: draft outline of tutorial

6 3/4 **DH tools part III:**

Part 1: TEI continued (from last week)
- Link to "Queer Text Encoding" project

Part 2: Practice rounds

Bring to class: draft outline of tutorial

7 3/11 **Tutorial presentations**

"Introduction to ___" tutorial presentations (45 min, groups of 3-4)

8 3/18 SPRING BREAK

Unit 2: Theoretical Approaches in DH

9 3/25 **Queer DH**
Readings:
1) Jose Esteban Munoz, "Introduction: Performing Disidentifications" from *Disidentifications*. 1999.
2) Fiona Barnett, Zach Blas, Micha Cárdenas, Jacob Gaboury, Jessica Marie Johnson, and Margaret Rhee, "Queer OS: A User's Manual", in *Debates in the Digital Humanities 2016.*
3) Jacob Gaboury, "Becoming NULL: Queer relations in the excluded

middle". *Women & Performance: a journal of feminist theory.* 2018.
4) Filipa Calado, "It Feels Like My Body's Coming Off" draft of paper in progress. 2026.
    a) In class: Ruberg, Boyd, Howe, "Toward a Queer Digital Humanities" in *Bodies of Information*.

Part 1: Discussion on readings
Part 2: Introduce final assignment

10 4/1 **Black DH**

Readings:
1) Amber Jamilla Musser, "Surface Play" from *Sensual Excess*. 2019.
2) Jessica Marie Johnson, "Markup Bodies: Black [Life] Studies and Slavery [Death] Studies at the Digital Crossroads". *Social Text*. 36: 57-79. 2018.
3) Kelly Baker Josephs and Roopika Risam, "Introduction: The Digital Black Atlantic" in *The Digital Black Atlantic*. 2021.
4) Angel David Nieves, "Digital Queer Witnessing Testimony, Contested Virtual Heritage, and the Apartheid Archive in Soweto, Johannesburg" in *The Digital Black Atlantic*. 2021. Link to Nieves' project.
5) Explore project: Colored Conventions

Part 1: Discuss readings
Part 2: Final projects

11 4/8 **Indigenous DH**

Guest speaker, Maria Fernanda Buitrago

Readings:
1) Eve Tuck and K. Wayne Yang, "Decolonization is not a metaphor", *Decolonization: Indigeneity, Education & Society* Vol. 1, No. 1, 2012, pp. 1-40.
2) Coppélie Cocq "Revisiting the digital humanities through the lens of Indigenous studies—or how to question the cultural blindness of our technologies and practices" in *JASIST* (2021)
3) Optional (highly recommended): Maria Fernanda Buitrago, "Guaceras and Campesinas" Master's Thesis.
4) Explore project: The Quipu Project
5) Explore project: Nichlas Emmons et al., When Rivers Were Trails

Part 1: Discussion
Part 2: Final projects

Unit 3: Topics in DH

12 4/15 **Archives**

Guest speaker, Stefano Morello, link to Stefano's The Punk Archiving Toolkit
Readings:
1) Matthew Kirschenbaum, "Every Contact Leaves a Trace" from *Mechanisms* (2008).
2) Christina Kamposiori "The role of Research Libraries in the creation, archiving, curation, and preservation of tools for the Digital Humanities" (2017).

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13	4/22	**Mapping** Guest speaker, Silvia Rivera Alfaro, link to Silvia's slides Readings: 1) Bonilla, Yarimar, and Max Hantel. 2016. "Visualizing Sovereignty." *Sx Archipelagos*, no. 1 (May 2016). 2) Aida Horaniet Ibañez, "Digital Humanities at the Intersection of Three Approaches to Data Visualisation: Statistical Graphics, Data Humanism, and Humanistic Interpretation." Center for Contemporary and Digital History (C2DH), University of Luxembourg. 2024
14	4/29	**Text Analysis** Readings: 1) Sayan Bhattacharyya "Text Analysis for Thought in the Black Atlantic" from *The Digital Black Atlantic* (2021) 2) So, Richard Jean and Edwin Roland. 2020. "Race and Distant Reading." PMLA 135.1: 59–73. (PDF) 3) Project: explore Voyant Tools, choose *Frankenstein* from the dropdown menu. Part 1: Discussion Part 2: Final projects
15	5/6	Final project workshops **Projects due on May 11th, 11:59pm**
16	5/13	**Final presentations**

List of DH projects by area:

Mapping
- Anti-eviction Mapping Project
- We Are Here: Indigenous Diaspora in Los Angeles
- Slave Revolt in Jamaica, 1760-1761
- Mapping Inequality
- Renewing Inequality
- The Decolonial Atlas

Data Visualization
- Responsible Datasets In Context
- The Data-Sitter's Club
- A Tale of Two Plantations
- The Shape of History
- Around DH in 80 days
- Data is beautiful: 10 of the best data visualization examples from history to today
- NYU Libraries: Introduction to Digital Humanities – Data Visualization
- Gendered Language in Teacher Reviews

Publishing
- Ed
- Debates site (uses Manifold)
- sx salon/sx archipelagos
- PubPub
- Scalar

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Archives
- Chicana por mi Raza
- CUNY Digital History Archive
- Documenting the Now
- TK Knowledge Labels
- Voices of Gay Rodeo

Misc.
- Center for Plants and Culture
- Reviews in Digital Humanities

Grading and Assignments
A rubric or some other breakdown of grading will be provided for each assignment before it is due. Revisions to graded work will be permitted as long as it is turned in by the due date of the final project. Late work will be accepted with approval from the instruction - please just email me as soon as you think you might need an extension.

Any uses of generative AI must be credited with a brief description of how it was used for each assignment. This includes using AI to help brainstorm, outline, or write any materials.

The breakdown of the grade for the course is the following:

Discussion participation	15%
Discussion leadership	15%
Tutorial	30%
Final project	40%

Pratt's grading scale:

Superior work:	A 4.0 (96-100)	A- 3.7 (90-95)	
Very good work:	B+ 3.3 (87-89)	B 3.0 (83-86)	B-2.7 (80-82)
Marginally satisfactory:	C+ 2.3 (77-79)	C 2.0 (73-76)	
Failed:	F 0.0 (0-72)		

Discussion leadership (20%)

Each student will co-lead one of the discussions in the second half of the semester. The leader(s) will be responsible for reading each of the assigned readings and identifying key themes for the class discussion to focus around.

The leader(s) will come to class ready to do a short presentation 5-10 minutes on the readings, summarizing the main ideas from each one.

Additionally, leads will come to class with a list of questions to guide the discussion (2 questions per reading), as well as key passages to discuss in class with some guidance/prompts for discussion (3 passages total, spread across all readings).

Your discussion questions and list of passages will be due on canvas on the day that you present.

Signups:

What is the digital humanities?	1) ____Ellie_____ 2) ____Bridget_____
Humanities data	1) ____Jade_____ 2) ____Yonni_____

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Queer DH	1) ____Margaret_____ 2) ____Sg_____
Black DH	1) _____Jordin_____ 2) _____Makeda_____
Indigenous DH	1) _____Carlos_____ 2) _____Alexa_____
Text Analysis	1) _____Quadri_____ 2) _____

"Introduction to _____" Tutorial (40%)

At the end of the first half of the semester, you will present a 30 minute tutorial on a DH tool of your choice. You will work in groups of 3.

Link to assignment guidelines

Class participation (20%)

Active and engaged participation in class discussion on class readings as well as other activities. Highest emphasis will be on demonstrating familiarity with class readings.

Final project (40% total)

Due May 9th, and presented on May 13th.

Students may choose between a) writing an environmental scan; b) writing a research paper, and c) creating and documenting a dataset; and d) building out the tutorial to a longer, published version. For the dataset and tutorial options, you may work collectively (see below for instructions for group projects).

Guidelines for the assignment are available here.

Group projects should scale in complexity with the number of people in the group. Additionally, each member must email me a short statement (max. 300 words), copied to all other group members, describing their individual contributions to the project; alternatively, a single statement from the group is acceptable, provided it is agreed upon and copied to all.

Portfolio

Work completed for this course may be included in your portfolio. Most of the work for this class will involve technology, research, and critical approaches to our field.

For more information on each program's portfolio requirements, please visit the program's respective webpage:

MS Library & Information Science: Portfolio - http://bit.ly/prattmslisportfolio
MS Information Experience Design: Portfolio - http://bit.ly/prattmsixdportfolio2
MS Data Analytics and Visualization: Portfolio - http://bit.ly/prattmsdavportfolio2
MS Museums and Digital Culture: Portfolio - http://bit.ly/prattmsmdcportfolio2

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Acknowledgements
This syllabus is based on or takes inspiration from syllabuses from Claudia Berger's syllabus for the same course, and Profs. Jojo Karlin and Krystyna Michael's Introduction to Digital Humanities Fall 2025 course.

Pratt Institute-Wide Policies

Students are allowed three individual absences for any reason; no documentation or notice is required. If you miss a session, be sure to complete the readings, consult your classmates or the professor about the class, and (as always) demonstrate your knowledge of the material in later sessions. Upon a fourth or fifth absence, your grade will be lowered by one mark for each absence (e.g., A to A-); students who miss six or more sessions will not pass the course. If you encounter significant health issues during the semester, you should provide documentation to the Office of Health and Counseling and discuss options for completing work with your professors.

Academic Integrity Code

Academic integrity at Pratt means using your own and original ideas in creating academic work. It also means that if you use the ideas or influence of others in your work, you must acknowledge them. For more information on Pratt's Academic Integrity Standards, please visit http://bit.ly/prattacademicintegrity.

Students with Disabilities and Accessibility

Pratt Institute is committed to the full inclusion of all students. If you are a student with a disability and require accommodations, please contact the Learning/Access Center (L/AC) at LAC@pratt.edu to schedule an appointment to discuss these accommodations. Students with disabilities who have already registered with the L/AC are encouraged to speak to the professor about accommodations they may need to produce an accessible learning environment.

Requests for accommodation should be made as far in advance as reasonably possible to allow sufficient time to make any necessary modifications to ensure the relevant classes, programs, or activities are readily accessible. The Learning/Access Center is available to Pratt students, confidentially, with additional resources and information to facilitate full access to all campus programs and activities and provide support related to any other disability-related matters.

For more information, please visit http://www.pratt.edu/accessibility/.

Bias, Discrimination and Sexual Misconduct

Pratt Institute seeks to provide an environment that is free of bias, discrimination, and harassment. If you have been the victim of harassment, discrimination, bias, or sexual misconduct, we encourage you to report this.

To report an incident regarding a student, faculty, or staff member, please fill out the Bias, Discrimination & Sexual Misconduct Incident Form (http://bit.ly/pratt_biasform). Submitting an incident report allows the Institute to investigate and take appropriate actions to address your concerns.

If you inform me (your professor) of an issue of harassment, discrimination or bias, or sexual misconduct I will keep the information as private as I can, however, I am required to bring it to the attention of the institution's Title IX Coordinator. You can access Title IX services by emailing titleix@pratt.edu. You can also speak to someone confidentially by contacting our non-mandatory reporters: Health Services at 718-399-4542, Counseling Services 718-687-5356 or Campus Ministries 718-596-4840.

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In incidents where you may prefer to place an anonymous report in confidence, you are encouraged to submit reports through EthicsPoint (http://bit.ly/pratt_ethicspoint).

If you have any questions about filing or completing an incident report, please contact the Director of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion or the Title IX Coordinator, by emailing bias@pratt.edu.

For more information, please refer to the Community Standards webpage: http://bit.ly/prattcommunitystandards.